
File Case #12

Case ID: 199M **Case Title:** The "Empty Sarcophagus" Case **Date:** December 1, 2018
Status: Closed

Crime Summary: An international smuggling ring was discovered trafficking **Egyptian artifacts stolen from the National Museum**. The artifacts were taken out of the country and sent to private collectors abroad.

Modus Operandi (M.O.): The ring used a **designer furniture transport company as a front**. The ancient artifacts (amulets, vessels, statuettes) were concealed in **secret compartments** inside replicas of large, modern furniture. These pieces were sent through **legitimate shipping channels**, passing superficial customs inspections.

Persons of Interest:

- **Main Suspect: Dr. Elena Morales**, a respected art historian and museum curator, who used her position to **falsify inventory records**.
- **Collaborators:** A logistics company and a network of intermediaries in Europe.

Key Evidence:

- An **anonymous tip to Interpol** about a suspicious shipment to Switzerland.
- **High-intensity X-rays at customs** that revealed dense objects hidden inside a designer dining table.
- Financial records showing **large payments from known art collectors** to accounts linked to Dr. Morales.
- Encrypted emails between Morales and the logistics company discussing the **"special contents."**

Forensic Analysis: Analysis of the museum's inventory records revealed **discrepancies** that matched the shipment dates. Dr. Morales had been **replacing authentic artifacts with high-quality replicas**, a change undetectable without expert examination.

Resolution: **Dr. Morales and her accomplices were arrested**. A large portion of the stolen artifacts was recovered, including the outer panel of a sarcophagus that gave the case its name. The network was **completely dismantled**.